UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

THURSDAY, 29 OCTOBER 2026

23 must-know stories, 23 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 946 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court strikes down Karnataka law validating ‘corrupt’ 2011 recruitment

The Supreme Court struck down the Karnataka Civil Services (Validation of Selection and Appointment of 2011 Batch Gazetted Probationers) Act, 2022 as unconstitutional. A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran ruled that the legislature cannot override judicial decisions upholding the cancellation of a tainted recruitment. The core issue involved the legislature attempting to validate appointments made through a 2011 recruitment process marred by widespread corruption and nepotism. The 2011 notification aimed to fill 362 posts, for which 1,38,307 candidates applied and 1,090 were eventually called for interviews. A CID investigation revealed serious manipulation, including call records linking candidates with KPSC members, identical interview marks, and evidence destruction. The Karnataka government previously cancelled the selection, and this cancellation was upheld earlier by both the Karnataka High Court and the Supreme Court. Despite the judicial setbacks, Karnataka enacted the 2022 validation law citing hardship for candidates not directly accused of individual wrongdoing. The Supreme Court directed the state government to issue a fresh recruitment notification for remaining vacancies under existing rules.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** Karnataka · **Who:** Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran, Supreme Court, Karnataka Government, Karnataka Public Service Commission · **Prelims:** The recruitment notification was issued on November 3, 2011, to fill 362 posts.; 1,38,307 candidates applied, 91,667 appeared for the preliminary exam, 6,211 qualified for the mains, and 1,090 were called for interviews.; The Criminal Investigation Department (CID) investigated the complaints and found serious manipulation.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the supremacy of constitutional courts and the doctrine of separation of powers against legislative overreach.; Emphasizes that systemic corruption and compromised integrity of an entire selection process cannot be cured by validation laws.*

Static — Public Service Commissions in India derive their constitutional basis from Article 315 to 323 of the Constitution, which provides for the establishment of a Public Service Commission for the Union and for each State. The Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) conducts examinations and interviews for recruitment to various civil services and posts under the state government. Administrative Tribunals, such as the Karnataka Administrative Tribunal (KAT), are established under Article 323A of the Constitution to adjudicate disputes relating to recruitment and conditions of service.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

The Hindu: read the source · free copy on indiatoday.in · also reported by LiveLaw, The Times of India, Bar & Bench

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Rajya Sabha passes Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026 to recognise digital banking records

The Rajya Sabha passed the Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026, to replace the colonial-era Bankers’ Books Evidence Act, 1891. The Lok Sabha had already passed the Bill earlier on August 5, paving the way for a modern legal framework. The core issue is updating the legal framework to govern the use of bank records as evidence in judicial proceedings. The Bill explicitly recognises electronic and digital records of bankers’ books as admissible, valid and legally enforceable evidence. Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman stated that the legislation creates a technology-neutral legal framework for banking records. Digital copies are admissible if they are true copies accurately derived from original records without unauthorized alterations or tampering. The Bill specifies special causes for compelling bank officer appearances, such as doubted accuracy, system interruptions, or non-compliance. The Centre is empowered to extend the application of this law to other financial sector entities via official notifications.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman · **Prelims:** The Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026 replaces the Bankers’ Books Evidence Act, 1891.; The Lok Sabha passed the Bill on August 5.; Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman introduced the technology-neutral framework details.

Why it matters — *Modernises judicial proceedings by legally admitting electronic and digital bank records.; Strengthens statutory protection for bank officers when banks are not party to legal proceedings.*

Static — The original Bankers' Books Evidence Act was enacted in 1891 during the British colonial period to facilitate the proof of entries in bankers' books without producing original ledgers. Parliamentary legislation in India requires passage by both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha followed by the President's assent to become an Act. Electronic records in Indian law draw foundational definitions from the Information Technology Act, 2000, regarding digital evidence admissibility.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Economy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Apex court asks Law Commission to review award execution rules

The Supreme Court stated that delays in executing arbitral awards defeat the core purpose of choosing arbitration over regular court litigation. The bench noted that the efficacy of an arbitration system depends on whether successful parties can realize their awards within a reasonable time. The court highlighted a case where Royal Construction Company Pvt. had been waiting 24 years to enforce an arbitral award won against NPCC in 2002. A bench headed by Justice Vikram Nath alongside Justices Sandeep Mehta and Aparesh Kumar Singh noted that such prolonged enforcement issues are not isolated instances. The Supreme Court officially requested the Law Commission of India to study the statutory and procedural framework governing award enforcement. The Law Commission is tasked with identifying practical bottlenecks, studying global jurisdictions, and suggesting legislative or procedural changes. The Commission will also examine whether domestic and foreign arbitral awards need separate enforcement procedures or a unified framework. The 2002 award originally directed NPCC to pay Royal Iraqi Dinars 2,23,777.14 and Rs 20 lakh, with 12 percent annual interest.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court bench led by Justice Vikram Nath, Law Commission of India, Royal Construction Company, NPCC · **Prelims:** The case involved Royal Construction Company Pvt. and National Projects Construction Corporation Ltd. (NPCC).; The original arbitral award was rendered in the year 2002.; The bench hearing the matter was headed by Justice Vikram Nath.

Why it matters — *Highlights the persistent execution bottlenecks plaguing India's alternative dispute resolution mechanism.; Paves the way for comprehensive structural and procedural reforms via the Law Commission to speed up commercial dispute resolution.*

Static — The Law Commission of India is a non-statutory body constituted periodically by the Government of India, usually headed by a retired Supreme Court judge or High Court chief justice, to recommend legal reforms. The Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996 governs arbitration, conciliation, and enforcement of arbitral awards in India, modeled largely on the UNCITRAL Model Law. Arbitral awards are executed under the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908, similar to decrees of a civil court, which often leads to lengthy execution hurdles.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Judgment, Award

Hindustan Times: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

DPDP Act: Newsrooms Will Shut Down Without Journalistic Exemption, Publishers Tell Supreme Court

The Digital News Publishers Association told the Supreme Court that newsrooms will shut down if journalists must seek pre-publication permission under the DPDP Act. A bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant issued notices to the Ministries of Law and Justice and MeitY, listing the matter for November 17. Senior advocate Madhavi Divan argued that lacking a journalistic exemption amounts to pre-censorship and undermines news gathering and investigative reporting. The plea challenges provisions of the DPDP Act and Rules, along with Section 44(3) which amends Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act. Petitioners stated that obligations like seeking consent, withdrawal of consent, and data erasure are incompatible with reporting on corruption and public affairs. The petition contends that the law violates Fundamental Rights under Articles 14, 19(1)(a), 19(1)(g), and 21 of the Constitution. The Supreme Court declined to grant an interim stay on the legislation without first hearing the government's response. The DNPA represents 21 digital news publishers, including media houses owned by the Ambani and Adani groups.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Digital News Publishers Association, Supreme Court, Chief Justice Surya Kant, Madhavi Divan · **Prelims:** The petition was filed by the Digital News Publishers Association (DNPA) representing 21 digital news publishers.; Section 44(3) of the DPDP Act amends Section 8(1)(j) of the Right to Information Act, 2005.; The Supreme Court bench was headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

Why it matters — *Highlights the vital tension between individual data privacy rights and the freedom of the press in investigative journalism.; Examines the constitutional validity of statutory amendments affecting transparency laws like the RTI Act.*

Static — The Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023 sets out the legal framework for processing digital personal data in India, balancing individual privacy rights with lawful data uses. Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution guarantees freedom of speech and expression, which historically encompasses freedom of the press in India. The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005 mandates timely response to citizen requests for government information, subject to exemptions under Section 8.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

telanganatoday.com: read the source · also reported by The Economic Times

GS2 MAKE NOTES

UAPA does not bar bail merely because accused is a foreign national: Supreme Court

The Supreme Court held that an accused person's foreign nationality alone does not bar the grant of bail under the UAPA. The bench clarified that the bail restriction under Section 43D(7) of UAPA applies only if the foreign national entered India illegally or without authorization. The Court emphasized that a lawful initial entry into India does not become unauthorized simply because the stay subsequently becomes illegal or authorization is revoked. The case involved Mohamed Rifas, a Sri Lankan national accused in a 2018 FIR regarding a conspiracy to disrupt communal harmony and commit terrorist acts. Rifas had secured statutory default bail in July 2018 because the prosecution failed to file a chargesheet within the prescribed time under Section 167(2) of the CrPC. The NIA later took over the case in January 2019, filed a chargesheet in January 2021, and a special court cancelled his bail in April 2022 under Section 43D(7). The Madras High Court set aside the cancellation in December 2023, and the Supreme Court dismissed the Union government's appeal against this relief.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court Bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi, Union of India, Mohamed Rifas · **Prelims:** Section 43D(7) of the UAPA restricts bail for foreign nationals entering India without authorization.; Default bail is granted under Section 167(2) of the CrPC when chargesheets are not filed on time.; The NIA took over the investigation into Mohamed Rifas in January 2019.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Protects the statutory right to default bail under Section 167(2) of the CrPC even in stringent anti-terror laws like the UAPA.; Clarifies the precise legal threshold required under Section 43D(7), ensuring foreign nationality without illegal entry does not automatically deny personal liberty.*

Static — The Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) is India's primary anti-terror legislation enacted in 1967 to prevent unlawful activities associations. Section 43D of the UAPA modifies the general provisions of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) regarding arrest, default bail, and police custody to deal stringently with terrorist offenses. Default bail under Section 167(2) of the CrPC is an indefeasible statutory right of an accused when the investigating agency fails to file a chargesheet within the stipulated 60 or 90 days.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Internal Security · Prelims angle: Judgment

Bar & Bench: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court on PMLA Bail: Twin Conditions under Section 45 Subordinate to Article 21

The judgment was delivered amid ongoing judicial scrutiny regarding prolonged pre-trial detention and the strict bail threshold under special economic legislations. The Supreme Court held that the twin bail conditions under Section 45 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act are subordinate to the fundamental right to personal liberty under Article 21.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** Section 45 of the PMLA contains the twin conditions for bail.; Article 21 guarantees the right to life and personal liberty.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens the primacy of fundamental rights over statutory restrictions in criminal jurisprudence.; Provides a vital judicial check against prolonged incarceration without trial in money laundering cases.*

Static — The Prevention of Money Laundering Act is a criminal law enacted in 2002 to prevent money laundering and confiscate property derived from laundered money. Section 45 of the PMLA imposes twin conditions for bail: the public prosecutor must get an opportunity to oppose bail, and the court must be satisfied that there are reasonable grounds that the accused is not guilty and is unlikely to commit any offence while on bail. Article 21 of the Constitution guarantees protection of life and personal liberty, stating that no person shall be deprived of life or personal liberty except according to procedure established by law.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Internal Security · Prelims angle: Judgment

TaxCorp AI: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court Rules Multiple Life Sentences Cannot Run Consecutively, Allows Superimposition to Preserve Separate Sentences

The Supreme Court ruled that life sentences awarded for multiple offences in a single trial cannot run consecutively. The trigger was a special leave petition filed by Raju Shantaram Koli challenging consecutive life sentences. The core issue is that directing humans to undergo life imprisonment twice is irrational because a person has only one life. A bench of Justices K V Vishwanathan and Arun Palli partly allowed the petition against the Bombay High Court order. The appellant was convicted for offences committed on April 29, 2010, including rape and murder of a 12-year-old girl. The trial court on September 27, 2013, and the Bombay High Court on June 10, 2016, had ordered consecutive life sentences. The apex court relied on the Constitution bench ruling in Muthuramalingam vs State (2016) to declare multiple life sentences must superimpose. Superimposition ensures that remission or commutation granted for one life sentence does not automatically extend to the other.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Justices K V Vishwanathan and Arun Palli · **Prelims:** Appellant: Raju Shantaram Koli; Offences involved: Sections 302 and 376 read with Section 342 of the IPC; Date of arrest: April 30, 2010

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the correct application of sentencing laws for heinous multiple crimes.; Prevents administrative anomalies regarding the calculation of remissions for life convicts.*

Static — Section 31 of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC) governs the sentencing of a person for multiple offences at one trial. Section 31(1) permits a court to direct sentences of imprisonment to run consecutively, but excludes imprisonment for life from this provision. A Constitution

bench in Muthuramalingam and Others vs State (2016) settled that multiple life sentences cannot run consecutively.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

deccanherald.com: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Union Cabinet gives nod to Rs. 7,396-crore panchayat scheme

The Union Cabinet approved the Pradhan Mantri Viksit Gram Swaraj Yojana as a Centrally Sponsored Scheme to strengthen village-level governance. The scheme runs from 2026-27 to 2030-31, aligning with the tenure of the Sixteenth Finance Commission. It has a total financial outlay of Rs. 7,395.55 crore, including a central share of Rs. 4,869.48 crore and a state share of Rs. 2,526.07 crore. The initiative aims to benefit about 32 lakh elected representatives and functionaries across more than 2.55 lakh Panchayats and traditional local bodies. It seeks to improve coordination among central ministries, state governments, and local bodies for better village development planning. The scheme will support preparing 2.55 lakh holistic Gram Panchayat Development Plans annually through the eGramSwaraj portal. It will support at least 2.55 lakh online audit plans annually and timely completion of audits through AuditOnline. The scheme deploys PANCHAM, an AI-enabled multilingual two-way communication platform in 17 Indian languages, alongside Gram Sabhas for public awareness. State governments and UT administrations will handle implementation by submitting annual action plans for approval to a Central Empowered Committee.

When: 2026-27 to 2030-31 · **Where:** All states and Union territories in India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Central Empowered Committee · **Prelims:** Total outlay of PM VGSY is Rs. 7,395.55 crore.; Central share of the scheme is Rs. 4,869.48 crore.; PANCHAM is an AI-enabled multilingual communication platform available in 17 Indian languages.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Enhances grassroots democracy by empowering 32 lakh elected representatives and functionaries across India.; Promotes transparency and financial accountability through digital platforms like eGramSwaraj and AuditOnline.*

Static — Panchayati Raj Institutions were given constitutional status through the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1992, adding Part IX to the Constitution. Article 243G empowers Panchayats with powers, authority, and responsibilities to prepare plans for economic development and social justice. Centrally Sponsored Schemes are projects backed by both the Centre and states, sharing funding in a predefined ratio to execute national priorities.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

msn.com: read the source · also reported by Times of India

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India-EU FTA likely to rollout in mid-2027, PM Modi to travel to Brussels for official signing in December: Top EU lawmaker

The India-EU Free Trade Agreement is expected to be signed by mid-December 2026, according to European Parliament's Foreign Affairs Committee Chair David McAllister. PM Narendra Modi is anticipated to travel to Brussels to attend the official signing ceremony on his way back from the US G20 summit. The agreement will undergo rigorous scrutiny by the European Parliament, which holds a consent vote expected by spring next year. The trade agreement is officially anticipated to enter into force by mid-2027 following parliamentary ratification. The EU lawmaker expressed confidence in a broad majority support within the European Parliament due to huge mutual economic benefits. McAllister welcomed progress on the investment protection agreement to boost European investor confidence and job creation in India. The FTA aims to help India and the EU de-risk supply chains, reduce dependencies, and enhance defence-industrial collaboration including cybersecurity.

When: mid-December 2026 and mid-2027 · **Where:** India and Brussels · **Who:** David McAllister and PM Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** David McAllister serves as the European Parliament's Foreign Affairs Committee Chair.; The signing of the India-EU FTA is expected by mid-December 2026.; The EU Parliament consent vote for the FTA is scheduled for spring.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It promises massive economic benefits and enhanced market access between two major global economic blocks.; It strengthens cooperation in de-risking supply chains, defence-industrial collaboration, and strategic autonomy.*

Static — The European Union is a political and economic union of 27 European member states, operating a single internal market and a standardized system of laws. Free Trade Agreements eliminate or reduce barriers to imports and exports between countries, promoting deeper economic integration and bilateral trade. The European Parliament is the directly elected legislative body of the European Union, which must provide its consent for international trade treaties to enter into force.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Polity & Constitution, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Times of India: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

BRICS Transport Ministers adopt declaration on sustainable mobility, logistics cooperation under India's Chairship

The 3rd BRICS Transport Ministers' Meeting concluded in Nagpur, Maharashtra, with the adoption of a Ministerial Declaration. The meeting was held under India's BRICS Chairship for 2026 to strengthen transport cooperation across member nations. Senior officials finalized the agenda during the 3rd BRICS Transport Working Group meeting held from July 9 to 10. The declaration was adopted unanimously, focusing on sustainable infrastructure, green mobility, aviation, logistics, and railway research. Key priority areas include Sustainable Aviation Fuel, transport decarbonisation, urban mobility hubs, and a BRICS Railway Research Network. The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways stated that the declaration offers a roadmap for resilient, future-ready transport systems. Union Minister Nitin Gadkari thanked participating delegations for their constructive engagement and consensus-based approach. India reaffirmed its commitment to ensuring a smooth transition of agreed initiatives to the next BRICS Chairship.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** Nagpur, Maharashtra · **Who:** Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari, Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) · **Prelims:** The 3rd BRICS Transport Ministers' Meeting was held in Nagpur, Maharashtra.; The meeting took place under India's BRICS Chairship for 2026.; The 3rd BRICS Transport Working Group Senior Officials' Meeting was held from July 9 to 10.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a collaborative roadmap for sustainable, resilient, and future-ready transport systems across BRICS nations.; Promotes green mobility initiatives like Sustainable Aviation Fuel and transport decarbonisation.*

Static — BRICS is an intergovernmental organization comprising major emerging economies, originally formed as BRIC in 2009 before South Africa joined in 2010. The grouping aims to promote peace, security, development, and cooperation among member states while reforming multilateral financial and political institutions. India holds the BRICS Chairship for 2026, hosting various ministerial and technical meetings to drive consensus on global issues.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Economy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India, Indonesia deepen strategic coordination on global governance, Indo-Pacific, BRICS in joint statement

India and Indonesia issued a joint statement during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's State Visit to Indonesia, reaffirming their commitment to closer coordination in regional and multilateral forums. The leaders noted prevailing geopolitical challenges, supply chain disruptions, and economic issues, stressing the need for strategic convergence and a more representative world order. Both countries agreed to pursue meaningful reforms of international institutions, including the comprehensive reform and expansion of the United Nations Security Council in both categories. The joint statement highlighted the need to reform the global financial architecture and support a rules-based, fair, and inclusive international trading system centered on the WTO. Indonesia reaffirmed its full support for India's BRICS Chairship in 2026, while India expressed commitment to supporting Indonesia's role as a BRICS member. The leaders reaffirmed their commitment to a free, open, rules-based, and inclusive Indo-Pacific region, adhering to international law and UNCLOS 1982. President Prabowo appreciated India's continued support for ASEAN unity and centrality, encouraging synergy between the AOIP and India's IPOI. The leaders welcomed cooperation under the India-Indonesia-Australia trilateral mechanism and discussed collaboration in maritime domain awareness and the blue economy.

When: July 6-8, 2026 · **Where:** Indonesia · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto · **Prelims:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi made a State Visit to Indonesia from July 6-8.; Indonesia reaffirmed its support for India's BRICS Chairship in 2026.; The Shared Vision of India-Indonesia Maritime Cooperation in the Indo-Pacific was announced in 2018.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights growing bilateral strategic convergence between India and Indonesia in the Indo-Pacific region.; Reinforces joint demands for reforming global governance structures like the UN Security Council and the global financial architecture.*

Static — India and Indonesia share a long-standing maritime and cultural history, formalized through a Strategic Partnership established in 2005 and upgraded to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in 2018. The Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) is an intergovernmental organization founded in 1997 to strengthen regional cooperation and sustainable development within the Indian Ocean region. BRICS is an intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, and newly added member states, aimed at promoting peace, security, development, and cooperation.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by The Economic Times, Hindustan Times

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

IMF Warns Super El Niño Risks to Indian Economy, Highlights, Impacts

The IMF stated that the impact of weather events like the Super El Nino has not yet materialised for India. India continues to serve as an engine of growth for the global economy despite potential climate risks. The IMF identified lower crop yields, increased food price inflation, and reduced household purchasing power as risks. IMF Communications Director Julie Kozack highlighted these factors during a press conference in Washington. The IMF raised India's growth forecast for fiscal year 2027 and fiscal year 2028 to 7 per cent earlier in the month. Previous projections from July stood at 6.4 per cent for FY27 and 6.7 per cent for FY28 respectively. Growth projections will be reassessed in the January World Economic Outlook update if weather risks materialise. Current strong growth momentum is supported by robust domestic demand and strong services activity in India.

When: October 29 · **Where:** Washington · **Who:** Julie Kozack, IMF Communications Director · **Prelims:** IMF raised India's growth forecast for FY27 and FY28 to 7 per cent.; Previous July projections for FY27 and FY28 were 6.4 per cent and 6.7 per cent respectively.; Julie Kozack serves as the IMF Communications Director.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's position as a major bright spot and growth engine for the slowing global economy.; Emphasizes the persistent vulnerability of domestic inflation, crop yields, and household purchasing power to climate phenomena.*

Static — The International Monetary Fund (IMF) is an international organization of 190 member countries, working to foster global monetary cooperation and secure financial stability. The IMF publishes the World Economic Outlook (WEO) report twice a year, providing detailed analyses of global economic developments. El Nino is a climate pattern characterized by the warming of surface waters in the eastern Pacific Ocean, impacting global weather systems.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations, Geography · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by Vajiram & Ravi

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India's GDP growth seen at 7.35% in Q2 FY27 amid risks: Finance ministry

The Ministry of Finance estimated India's real GDP growth at 7.35 per cent for the July-September quarter of FY27, compared to 7.8 per cent in April-June. The growth projection is supported by strong domestic demand, high consumption, industrial activity, and robust high-frequency indicators. Policymakers aim to sustain economic activity and safeguard price stability during the second half of the financial year amid various risks. High-frequency indicators such as GST collections, E-way bill generation, freight logistics, and automobile sales pointed to sustained domestic demand. Bank credit growth remained strong at 21.6 per cent year-on-year as of September 30, supporting consumption, investment, and exports. The department used a nowcasting model introduced in the Economic Survey 2025-26 to arrive at the Q2 FY27 growth estimate. Inflation risks include elevated crude oil prices, food inflation, an uncertain kharif crop outlook, and an intensifying El Niño event. Supply-side interventions like 'Kanda Express' onion releases, sugar stockholding limits, and edible oil duty cuts aim to ease kitchen staple prices. India's foreign exchange reserves remained adequate, providing an import cover of 10.3 months to buffer against external global uncertainties.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Finance · **Prelims:** Estimated Q2 FY27 GDP growth is 7.35 per cent.; Q1 FY27 real GDP growth was recorded at 7.8 per cent.; Bank credit growth stood at 21.6 per cent year-on-year as of September 30.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides official economic tracking and near-term outlook for India's growth trajectory.; Highlights critical domestic and external risks, including inflation, energy volatility, and geopolitical tensions.*

Static — GDP nowcasting involves using high-frequency real-time economic indicators to predict gross domestic product growth before official quarterly estimates are released. High-frequency indicators like GST collections, E-way bill generations, and PMI data serve as immediate proxies for tracking economic activity. The Reserve Bank of India manages liquidity and monetary policy measures to contain secondary inflation effects and exchange rate volatility.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats, Report/Index

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on deccanchronicle.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government extends PLI scheme for textiles until 2033-34 to boost MSME participation and investments

The government announced the extension of the PLI scheme and the reopening of its application window. The government extended the Production Linked Incentive scheme for the textiles sector until 2034 and relaxed investment and turnover criteria to boost MSME participation. This change aims to encourage more companies to participate by relaxing eligibility norms for investment. The textiles ministry has reduced the minimum turnover requirement for certain manufacturers from Rs. 200 crore to Rs. 100 crore. A reopened application portal will accept submissions for manufacturing various textiles from November 1 to December 31.

When: November 1 to December 31 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Textiles Ministry · **Prelims:** The PLI scheme for textiles has been extended until 2033-34.; The minimum turnover requirement for certain manufacturers was reduced from Rs. 200 crore to Rs. 100 crore.; The application portal

opens for submissions on November 1 and closes on December 31.

Why it matters — *Encourages wider participation of smaller manufacturers and MSMEs in the textile sector.; Helps attract fresh investments and expands domestic manufacturing capabilities.*

Static — The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme aims to boost domestic manufacturing, attract investments, and enhance export competitiveness across key sectors. PLI schemes provide financial incentives calculated on incremental sales over a base year to eligible companies manufacturing in India. The Ministry of Textiles implements sectoral PLI initiatives to promote MMF apparel, MMF fabrics, and technical textile products.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

Economic Times: read the source · also reported by The Hindu

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court to vet RBI's digital fraud regulations before notification, says banks must compensate victims

The Supreme Court announced it will examine the Reserve Bank of India's proposed anti-cyber fraud regulations before they are officially notified. The suo motu proceedings were initiated after a senior citizen couple lost Rs. 1.05 crore to impersonators using forged judicial orders in a digital arrest scam. The Supreme Court mandated that financial institutions must compensate cyber fraud victims when the crime stems from a failure of due diligence. The compensation ordered must be at least equivalent to the customer's actual monetary loss incurred during the fraud. The Bench emphasized mandatory safeguards including temporary suspension of unusual transactions inconsistent with past track records, automated reporting, and physical verification. Attorney General R Venkataramani informed the Court that bank employees had prevented fraud and complaints had decreased by about 50%. The Attorney General requested time for technical integration, proposing draft notification by November 30 and full operationalization by December 31. The Court directed the RBI to submit the draft regulations and a complete list of authorised financial institutions by the next hearing.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court Bench led by CJI Surya Kant, RBI, Attorney General R Venkataramani, Amicus Curiae NS Nappinai · **Prelims:** A senior citizen couple lost Rs. 1.05 crore in the specific digital arrest case heard by the Court.; The Attorney General proposed notification of regulations by November 30 and operationalisation by December 31.; Senior Advocate NS Nappinai is assisting the Court as amicus curiae in the proceedings.

Why it matters — *Enforces strict legal liability on financial institutions for lapses in cyber fraud prevention and customer protection.; Addresses the rising menace of sophisticated financial crimes like digital arrest scams targeting vulnerable citizens.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India functions as the apex judicial body under Part V of the Constitution, possessing wide powers under Article 142 to do complete justice. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. Suo motu jurisdiction allows courts to take up matters independently on their own motion without a formal petition filed by an affected party.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Bar & Bench: read the source · also reported by Hindustan Times, The Hindu, Times of India, LiveLaw

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India's Mineral Exchanges: Benefits, Rules and Key Challenges

India has established a formal regulatory framework for Mineral Exchanges to create a single, transparent electronic marketplace for minerals. The reform aims to replace fragmented negotiations and auctions with representative prices reflecting actual demand and supply. Small and medium miners previously faced limited bargaining power, price opacity, market fragmentation, and information asymmetry. Amendments to the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act and the Mineral Exchange Rules, 2026, form the legal bedrock. The Indian Bureau of Mines under the Ministry of Mines is designated to register and regulate mineral exchanges for non-coal and non-atomic minerals. PTC India and MCX have already set up subsidiaries to launch mineral exchanges. Exchanges will initially trade physical mineral ores like iron ore, bauxite, limestone, and manganese ore on a spot, delivery-based contract basis. Future phases may include critical minerals like lithium, nickel, cobalt, graphite, and rare earth elements. Key challenges ahead include ensuring market liquidity, standardising mineral grades, and preventing market concentration by large producers or buyers.

When: 2026-10-29 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Mines, Indian Bureau of Mines, PTC India, MCX · **Prelims:** Section 18B of the MMDR Act provides for promoting mineral markets and trading via mineral exchanges.; The Indian Bureau of Mines is designated to register and regulate mineral exchanges for minerals other than coal, lignite, and atomic minerals.; Exchanges will initially focus on physical mineral ores in spot, delivery-based contracts, starting with iron ore, bauxite, limestone, and manganese ore.

Why it matters — *Improves cost planning for downstream industries like steel, aluminium, cement, and renewable energy manufacturing.; Empowers smaller miners by providing better visibility on transaction volumes, quality specifications, and prevailing prices.*

Static — The Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act governs the mining sector in India and is amended periodically to introduce major structural reforms. The Indian Bureau of Mines is a subordinate office under the Ministry of Mines, engaged in promotion of conservation, scientific development of mineral resources and environmental protection. Mineral pricing and distribution in India have traditionally relied on bilateral negotiated contracts, captive mines, and state-run auctions rather than unified electronic exchanges.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Geography, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

Agriculture & Allied

GS3 MAKE NOTES

24th Instalment of PM-KISAN

The 24th instalment of the PM-KISAN scheme is scheduled to be released on Friday, October 30, 2026, in Banaskantha, Gujarat. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will release the financial assistance during a special programme ahead of Diwali. More than Rs. 18,690 crore will be transferred directly to over 9.34 crore eligible farmer families via Direct Benefit Transfer. Under the PM-KISAN scheme, eligible landholding farmer families receive Rs. 6,000 annually in three equal instalments of Rs. 2,000 each. Beneficiaries are advised to verify their registration details, e-KYC status, Aadhaar, and bank account information to avoid payment delays. Certain categories, including income-tax payers and institutional landholders, are excluded from receiving benefits under the scheme. The PM Events platform lists the programme at 10:00 AM, while the official webcast coverage starts at 9:00 AM IST.

When: October 30, 2026 · **Where:** Banaskantha, Gujarat · **Who:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** Amount transferred in 24th instalment: More than Rs. 18,690 crore.; Number of beneficiary farmers: Over 9.34 crore.; Annual financial assistance under PM-KISAN: Rs. 6,000.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides vital liquidity support to agricultural households for purchasing seeds, fertilisers, and managing essential farming inputs.; Direct Benefit Transfer mechanism ensures transparency and prevents leakage in the delivery of welfare benefits.*

Static — Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) is a Central Sector Scheme with 100% funding from the Government of India. The scheme was launched to provide income support to all landholding farmer families across the country to supplement their financial needs. Financial assistance of Rs. 6,000 per year is released in three four-monthly instalments of Rs. 2,000 directly into the bank accounts of beneficiaries.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

Indian Express: read the source · free copy on msn.com · also reported by PIB

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Minimum Support Price for Rabi: Marketing Season 2027-28

The government announced higher Minimum Support Prices for six mandated Rabi crops for the marketing season 2027-28. This revision provides farmers with increased price assurance and helps encourage crop diversification for the upcoming cycle. Safflower received the largest increase of 675 rupees per quintal compared to the previous marketing season. Rapeseed and mustard saw an increase of 413 rupees per quintal, while lentil prices increased by 390 rupees per quintal. The government estimates that approximately 90,962 crore rupees will be paid to farmers for around 324 lakh metric tonnes of produce. MSP is calculated by considering production costs, including inputs, equipment depreciation, working-capital interest, and family labour. The latest rates maintain the policy of setting MSP at least 50 percent above the estimated cost of production. Procurement and actual payments depend on applicable procurement arrangements, eligibility requirements, and local registration details.

When: 2027-28 Marketing Season · **Who:** Government of India · **Prelims:** Safflower received the largest MSP increase of 675 rupees per quintal.; Rapeseed and mustard MSP increased by 413 rupees per quintal.; Lentil prices increased by 390 rupees per quintal.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides financial predictability and mitigates price risk for small and marginal farmers.; Maintains the policy of setting MSP at least 50 percent above the estimated cost of production across mandated crops.*

Static — The Minimum Support Price is a form of market intervention by the Government of India to insure agricultural producers against any sharp fall in farm prices. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs for 22 mandated crops and fair and remunerative prices for sugarcane. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the final decision on announcing MSPs based on CACP recommendations and views of state governments.

Syllabus: GS3: Agriculture & Allied

PIB: read the source · free copy on msn.com

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India Leads Globally with Green Hydrogen Offtake Commitments Exceeding 5.5 Lakh MTPA Till October 2026

India has achieved firm and signed green hydrogen offtake commitments reaching 5,55,610 metric tonnes per annum as of October 2026. These commitments represent approximately 11 percent of the National Green Hydrogen Mission's production target. During 2026 alone, Indian companies signed 18 new offtake agreements supplying over 4 lakh MTPA of green hydrogen equivalent. Since the launch of the National Green Hydrogen Mission in 2023, a total of 23 offtake contracts have been signed. More than 70 percent of the committed volumes are earmarked for exports to major international markets like Japan, Germany, and South Korea. The agreements are expected to attract investments exceeding Rs. 90,000 crore, equivalent to approximately USD 9.5 billion. Domestic demand is also expanding through the SIGHT programme, supporting low-carbon adoption in fertilizer units and oil refineries. Expected outcomes of the mission include 5 MMTPA annual production, 125 GW renewable capacity, and over 6 lakh jobs by 2030.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Indian companies, international buyers in Japan, Germany, South Korea, and Sri Lanka · **Prelims:** Firm offtake commitments reached 5,55,610 MTPA as of October 2026.; The National Green Hydrogen Mission has an initial financial outlay of Rs. 19,744 crore.; The mission targets annual production of at least 5 million metric tonnes by 2030.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Positions India as a major global supplier in the emerging clean energy and green fuel market.; Attracts investments exceeding Rs. 90,000 crore and creates over 6 lakh full-time jobs by 2030.*

Static — The National Green Hydrogen Mission was approved by the Union Cabinet with an initial financial outlay of Rs. 19,744 crore up to 2029-30. The mission aims to make India a global hub for the production, use, and export of green hydrogen and its derivatives. By 2030, the mission targets an annual green hydrogen production capacity of at least 5 million metric tonnes.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy, Economy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

PIB: read the source · free copy on indianmasterminds.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Graded Response Action Plan in Delhi-NCR

The Commission for Air Quality Management invoked Stage I of the Graded Response Action Plan as Delhi's Air Quality Index entered the Poor category. GRAP is a set of short-term emergency measures designed to reduce air pollution when air quality deteriorates in Delhi and NCR districts. First notified by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in January 2017, GRAP operates through four increasingly stringent stages. State governments implement the measures through respective orders and are legally bound to comply with directions from the Commission. The Commission for Air Quality Management replaced the Environment Pollution Prevention and Control Authority in 2021 to ensure better enforcement. Under Stage III, restrictions apply to BS-III petrol and BS-IV or older diesel light motor vehicles, while Stage IV restricts construction and truck entry. Winter pollution in Delhi-NCR is driven by low wind speeds, vehicular emissions, construction dust, stubble burning, and festive-season firecrackers. An analysis by the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air found no consistent improvement in winter air quality over four years.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** Delhi-NCR · **Who:** Commission for Air Quality Management · **Prelims:** GRAP was first notified by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change in January 2017.; The CAQM replaced the Environment Pollution Prevention and Control Authority in the year 2021.; Stage III of GRAP restricts BS-III petrol and BS-IV or older diesel light motor vehicles.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the persistent challenge of severe winter air pollution in the National Capital Region.; Raises critical questions regarding the long-term effectiveness of emergency-only pollution control frameworks.*

Static — The Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021 established the statutory CAQM to replace the EPCA. The Graded Response Action Plan was first notified in January 2017 by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change following Supreme Court directions. GRAP functions as an emergency response mechanism divided into four distinct stages based on pre-determined Air Quality Index thresholds.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

31st UN Climate Change Conference (COP31) 2026, Date, Venue

The 31st UN Climate Change Conference (COP31) is scheduled to be held in Antalya, Turkiye, from November 9 to November 20, 2026. The conference aims to focus on critical areas such as climate finance, clean energy transition, methane reduction, and climate adaptation. Key leadership roles include Murat Kurum as the COP31 President and Chris Bowen of Australia as the President of Negotiations. The World Leaders' Summit is scheduled for November 11-12, 2026, while preparatory Pre-COP31 meetings were held in Fiji and Tuvalu from October 5-8, 2026. Major agenda items include transitioning away from fossil fuels, addressing loss and damage, zero-waste initiatives, and strengthening Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs). Pre-COP discussions in Pacific island nations highlighted severe vulnerabilities like sea-level rise, coastal erosion, and ocean protection. India's priorities at COP31 center around climate finance, climate justice, renewable energy expansion, adaptation, and affordable technology transfer. Major challenges facing the summit include the climate finance gap, fossil fuel dependence, implementation gaps, and balancing energy security.

When: November 9-20, 2026 · **Where:** Antalya, Turkiye · **Who:** Murat Kurum, Chris Bowen · **Prelims:** COP31 will take place at the Antalya Expo Center in Turkiye from November 9 to November 20, 2026.; Murat Kurum is the COP31 President, and Chris Bowen of Australia is the President of Negotiations.; The Pre-COP31 meetings were held in Fiji and Tuvalu from October 5 to October 8, 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Serves as a crucial platform to address the mounting climate finance gap for developing nations.; Provides India an opportunity to advocate for climate justice, CBDR-RC, and technology transfer.*

Static — The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) was established in 1992 to set an overall framework for intergovernmental efforts to tackle climate change. The Kyoto Protocol, adopted in 1997, set legally binding emission-reduction targets for developed countries across designated commitment periods. The Paris Agreement of 2015 aims to hold the increase in global average temperature to well below 2 degC above pre-industrial levels while pursuing efforts to limit it to 1.5 degC.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations, Infrastructure & Energy

Vajiram & Ravi: read the source · also reported by PIB

Internal Security

GS3 MAKE NOTES

MHA unveils 'PRAHAAR', India's first national counter-terror policy

The Ministry of Home Affairs unveiled India's inaugural National Counter-Terrorism Policy and Strategy, titled PRAHAAR, on Monday. The policy was introduced to establish a structured national framework to address evolving security threats like cross-border terrorism, drone attacks, and cyber threats. The core issue centres on adopting a unified approach that rejects linking terrorism to any religion while maintaining a zero-tolerance policy against violence. The document explicitly highlights persistent challenges including cross-border terrorism, sleeper cells of global groups like Al-Qaeda and ISIS, and foreign-based destabilisation attempts. The term PRAHAAR means strike and represents seven core pillars ranging from prevention and swift response to international cooperation and societal resilience. Emerging technologies like drones, encrypted messaging apps, dark web platforms, and cryptocurrencies are identified as key enablers being exploited by terror handlers. Institutional nodes like the Multi Agency Centre and the National Investigation Agency are designated to lead intelligence sharing and prosecution. The strategy outlines a whole-of-government and whole-of-society approach, emphasizing human rights compliance, legal safeguards, and international cooperation.

When: Monday · **Where:** India · **Who:** Ministry of Home Affairs · **Prelims:** PRAHAAR is India's inaugural National Counter-Terrorism Policy and Strategy.; The policy document is eight pages long and was made available on the MHA website.; The term PRAHAAR means strike and represents seven core pillars.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It formalises a unified national framework for India's counter-terrorism measures amidst evolving digital and physical threats.; It addresses emerging security dimensions including cyber-enabled threats, cryptocurrency usage by terrorists, and drone-based attacks.*

Static — The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) is a key ministry of the Government of India tasked with internal security and domestic policy. The National Investigation Agency (NIA) was established under the National Investigation Agency Act, 2008, as the central counter-terrorism law enforcement agency. The Multi Agency Centre (MAC) functions as the apex counter-terrorism intelligence-sharing multi-agency coordination mechanism under the Intelligence Bureau.

Syllabus: GS3: Internal Security, Governance & Policy

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Rs 40,000-crore project for 8 next-gen corvettes cleared by Cabinet; GRSE, Goa Shipyard to build warships

The Cabinet Committee on Security approved a project worth over Rs 40,000 crore to construct eight Next-Generation Corvettes for the Indian Navy. The decision aims to boost naval firepower, enhance blue-water capabilities, and reinforce domestic defence manufacturing under Atmanirbhar Bharat. The contracts will be signed with state-owned shipbuilders Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers in Kolkata and Goa Shipyard Limited. The warships will feature an all-new in-house stealth design developed directly by the Indian Navy using advanced shipbuilding technologies. Each warship will have a displacement of approximately 2,000 tons and a speed profile of around 30 knots. The first vessel is targeted for delivery by 2030, with efforts underway to accelerate construction timelines. These multi-role platforms are designed for diverse maritime security missions across the Indian Ocean Region. The project aligns with the Prime Minister's vision of SAGAR for security and growth for all in the region.

When: 2026-10-30 · **Where:** Kolkata, Goa, Indian Ocean Region · **Who:** Cabinet Committee on Security, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Indian Navy, Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers, Goa Shipyard Limited · **Prelims:** Project cost: Over Rs 40,000 crore; Number of warships: Eight Next-Generation Corvettes; Builders: Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers, and Goa Shipyard Limited

> ***Why it matters —*** *Boosts domestic defence manufacturing and supports the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.; Enhances the Indian Navy's surface combat capabilities and maritime security in the Indian Ocean Region.*

Static — The Cabinet Committee on Security is the highest decision-making body on India's security affairs, chaired by the Prime Minister. Warship building in India relies heavily on Defence Public Sector Undertakings like GRSE, Goa Shipyard, and Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders. Atmanirbhar Bharat aims to reduce import dependence and promote domestic manufacturing and self-reliance in the defence sector.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on devdiscourse.com*

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

Tamil Nadu Cabinet decides to form commission headed by retd. HC judge to conduct Social Justice Survey

The Tamil Nadu Cabinet approved the formation of a Social Justice Commission to conduct a state-wide Social Justice Survey after the census. The commission will be constituted in February or March 2027, following the completion of the Centre's caste-based enumeration as part of the ongoing census. The core issue is strengthening the legal basis for Tamil Nadu's 69 percent reservation system, which currently rests largely on 1931 data.

The Hindu: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Bihar Cabinet approves MOU between WRD & NIH, Roorkee for ‘Flood Plain Zone Delineation Study’

The Bihar Cabinet cleared these infrastructure, industrial, and administrative decisions in its recent meeting. The Bihar Cabinet approved an MOU between the Water Resources Department and NIH Roorkee for a flood plain zone delineation study, alongside land allocation for industries and funds for state games. Cabinet approves 115 acres of land for a sugar mill and 151.58 acres for other industries.

The Hindu: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

ESIC Extends the New Amnesty Scheme 2025 till 31 December 2026: More Time for Employers and Insured Persons to Resolve Pending Cases

The Employees State Insurance Corporation extended the New Amnesty Scheme 2025 until 31 December 2026. The Ministry of Labour and Employment announced the three-month extension after reviewing representations from stakeholders. The scheme is a one-time dispute resolution initiative designed to reduce the backlog of court and tribunal cases. Court cases filed on or before 31 March 2025 are eligible for settlement under this scheme.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | AGREEMENT/MOU | AWARD | QUICK READ

15TH MEETING OF REVIEW COMMITTEE FOR NARMADA CONTROL AUTHORITY (RCNCA) ADOPTS THE OPINION OF Ld. AGI AND THE MEMORANDUM OF AGREEMENT DATED 7TH JULY, 2026 AND APPROVES THE MODALITIES FOR PAYMENT OF OUTSTANDING DUES OF NWDT AWARD PROJECTS WITHIN THIS FINANCIAL YEAR 2026-27

The 15th meeting of the Review Committee for Narmada Control Authority was held on 27th October 2026 to adopt the MoA and the Attorney General's opinion. The Review Committee for Narmada Control Authority adopted the Memorandum of Agreement and approved payment modalities for settling long-pending inter-State cost-sharing dues for the Sardar Sarovar Project within the 2026-27 financial year.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

Release of Sub-Sectoral Trial Index of Services Production (ISP) for August 2026 (Base Year 2024–25)

The Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (MoSPI) releases the Index of Services Production (ISP) for the month of August 2026 in respect of 19 sub-sectors, with base year 2024–25.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Cyrtodactylus dimensis: Scientists Discover New Gecko Species in Assam’s Dima Hasao

Researchers discovered a new species of gecko named Cyrtodactylus dimensis in Assam. The discovery was made in the Umrangso area located within the Dima Hasao district. The finding is significant as Dima Hasao forms a part of the Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot. Cyrtodactylus dimensis belongs to the specialized bent-toed gecko group of reptiles. This new addition brings the total number of described Cyrtodactylus species recorded in Assam to eight.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT | QUICK READ

Union Minister of Jal Shakti Shri C. R. Patil Chairs 19th Meeting of Ganga Flood Control Board in New Delhi

The 19th Meeting of the Ganga Flood Control Board was held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, chaired by Union Minister of Jal Shakti C R Patil. The meeting reviewed ongoing initiatives, strengthened interstate coordination, and deliberated on emerging approaches for effective flood management in the Ganga Basin. The core issue addressed was improving basin-level flood planning, drainage congestion, infrastructure development, and risk-informed technical standards across states.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | QUICK READ

Bihar Cabinet Approves MSME Policy 2026, Targets 1 Crore Entrepreneurial Families and Jobs

The Bihar Cabinet recently gave its official approval to the MSME Policy 2026. The Bihar Cabinet has approved the MSME Policy 2026 with the target of supporting one crore entrepreneurial families and generating one crore jobs.

KNN India: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

GSLV-F17/EOS-05 Mission

The upcoming launch of the GSLV-F17/EOS-05 mission has been scheduled by ISRO. ISRO announced the live streaming details for the GSLV-F17/EOS-05 mission.

ISRO: source

ECONOMY | QUICK READ

RBI releases data on ECB / FCCB / RDB for August 2026

The Reserve Bank of India has today released the data on External Commercial Borrowings (ECB), Foreign Currency Convertible Bonds (FCCB) and Rupee Denominated Bonds (RDB) through General Permission and Special Permission for the month of August 2026. Ajit Prasad Deputy General Manager (Communications) Press Release: 2026-2027/1403

RBI: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Maritime Board (Amendment) Bill passed in Assembly amid Opposition walkout

The Keralam Assembly passed the Maritime Board (Amendment) Bill, 2026, on Wednesday amid an opposition boycott. The Bill was introduced to restructure the state Maritime Board, set up a Maritime Land Bank and an enforcement wing, and revise contracts for 17 port projects. The core debate centers on port-led development versus the livelihood and traditional rights of coastal fishing communities.

The Hindu: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

UP Bar Council Mandatory 6-Month Internship Rule 2026: COP Eligibility, Rules and Supreme Court Judgment

The Bar Council of Uttar Pradesh introduced a mandatory 6-month internship rule for advocates applying for their Certificate of Practice. The measure was introduced in anticipation of approval from the Bar Council of India. Advocates who submitted their COP applications before November 1, 2026, are exempt from this new requirement.

studyiq.com: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | QUICK READ

Karnataka Cabinet approves separate Adivasi Development Corporation for PVTGs

The Karnataka Cabinet approved the establishment of a separate Adivasi Development Corporation for Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups with an initial allocation of Rs 336 crore. The new corporation aims to address the distinct living conditions and ensure that welfare benefits reach vulnerable tribal groups adequately without getting diluted under general Scheduled Tribes.

theprint.in: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | REPORT/INDEX | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Census Rules Amended: Anyone Can Now Be Appointed Enumerator, Sparking Transparency Row

The recent amendment to the census rules sparked a transparency row regarding data collection integrity. The government amended the census rules to permit anyone to be appointed as an enumerator, replacing traditional reliance on government officials.

The Live Nagpur: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

India votes in favour of UNGA resolution calling for end to US embargo on Cuba

India voted in favour of a United Nations General Assembly resolution calling for an end to the long-running US economic embargo against Cuba. The resolution was introduced amid acute shortages of medicines and food in Cuba caused by the severe humanitarian toll of the sanctions. India reiterated its opposition to legislation that adversely affects the sovereignty of other states and urged the repeal of extraterritorial laws.

Hindustan Times: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Afghanistan opium poppy cultivation surges despite Taliban government ban: UN

Opium poppy cultivation in Afghanistan more than quadrupled in 2026, reaching 43,000 hectares despite a Taliban government ban. Rampant poverty, climate disasters, dwindling aid, and banking isolation drove desperate farmers to return to the lucrative crop. The core issue highlights the difficulty of sustaining illicit crop bans without providing impoverished farmers viable long-term alternative livelihoods.

The Hindu: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | SCHEME | QUICK READ

From Unsafe Working Conditions To Safety And Dignity A Success Story Under The NAMASTE Scheme

A success story highlighting the impact of the NAMASTE Scheme was released by the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment. A sanitation worker from Rajasthan received safety equipment and livelihood support under the NAMASTE scheme to overcome hazardous working conditions.

PIB: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | QUICK READ

Advancing Universal and Inclusive Senior Care: Ayushman Vay Vandana Marks Two Years of Transforming Healthcare for Elderly Citizens

The initiative is in the news as it marks its second anniversary since being launched on October 29, 2024. Ayushman Vay Vandana has marked two years of extending Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY health coverage of up to Rs. 5 lakh per year to all Indian citizens aged 70 years and above regardless of income.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Nearly all global coral reefs face collapse within 50 years: IUCN

The release of the latest IUCN assessment report warning of widespread coral reef collapse put the issue in the news. The IUCN reported that nearly all global coral reefs face functional collapse within the next 50 years due to severe climate pressures.

Eco-Business: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Supreme Court reserves verdict on CBI probe into I-PAC raid obstruction

The Supreme Court reserved its judgment on a plea by the Enforcement Directorate seeking a fair CBI probe into an alleged raid obstruction. The trigger was the ED's petition regarding the January 8, 2026 incident where searches at the I-PAC office in Kolkata were obstructed. The core debate centers on whether an independent central investigation is necessary given that senior police officials were named and could influence the probe.

deccanherald.com: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

India’s Ramsar Network Expands Nearly Fourfold Since 2014, Reaching 103 Wetlands Across 28 States and UTs

India's network of internationally recognised Ramsar wetlands has expanded nearly fourfold since 2014, reaching 103 sites by October 2026. The network now covers more than 13.87 lakh hectares across 28 States and Union Territories, making India rank first in Asia and third globally. Recent additions include Surha Tal in Uttar Pradesh as the 100th site, Glaw Lake in Arunachal Pradesh, and Sukhna Wetland and Sauj Jheel.

indianmasterminds.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

Putin Arrives in New Delhi for BRICS Summit; Bilateral Talks with PM Modi Today

Russian President Vladimir Putin arrived in New Delhi on Friday to attend the 18th BRICS Summit. The visit follows PM Modi and President Putin's recent meeting on the sidelines of the SCO Summit in Bishkek. During the Bishkek meeting, PM Modi called for an end to the Russia-Ukraine conflict, stating the world needs to move from endless war to the end of war.

ddnews.gov.in: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Underground cabling project, PM Surya Ghar scheme launched in Tripura

Tripura Chief Minister Manik Saha and power minister Ratan Lal Nath laid the foundation stone for an underground cabling project under the Agartala Smart Grid initiative. They also launched the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana under the Utility-Led Aggregation (ULA) model in the state. The initiatives aim to upgrade power infrastructure in Agartala and offer assistance to low-income households.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 Disinvestment as Key Economic Strategy

The article discusses disinvestment as a key economic strategy, highlighting its role in unlocking public assets and managing expenditure pressures. The author argues that calibrated disinvestment can serve as an interim measure given that privatization of public sector enterprises is a long journey. DIPAM data shows the government mobilized Rs 62,124 crore through disinvestment and asset monetization during April to September 2026. Disinvestment receipts help provide additional fiscal resources as net tax revenue grew by 3.4 percent while capital expenditure increased by over 18 percent.

The Hindu

GS1 GS2 India Must Build a Holistic Care System

India's development strategy has focused heavily on physical and digital infrastructure while leaving care work as an under-recognised foundation of growth. Without affordable care services, families and particularly women carry heavy unpaid work burdens, leading to lost economic and professional opportunities. A holistic care system is debated as a vital framework connecting childcare, eldercare, disability support, and healthcare to support inclusive growth and Viksit Bharat 2047.

The Hindu

GS2 Open to investigation: on the challenge to the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023

The Supreme Court issued notice on a petition by the Digital News Publishers Association challenging the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023. The petitioner argues that requiring journalist consent and allowing data erasure will close down newsrooms and act as pre-censorship. The core issue is the absence of an explicit journalistic carve-out in the Act, unlike jurisdictions like the European Union and Britain. Senior Advocate Madhavi Divan stated that seeking subject permission before reporting would allow subjects to destroy evidence and intimidate witnesses.

The Hindu

GS2 Deemed ineligible: on the Supreme Court and SIR

The Supreme Court's critical observations on the structural flaws of the SIR have brought the issue into prominent focus. The Supreme Court has pointed out significant design flaws in the SIR that render certain individuals ineligible, sparking debate over constitutional validity. The Supreme Court has pointed to the SIR’s flaws by design

The Hindu

GS3 Best of Opinion: Small exporters need govt support in the face of CBAM

It was featured in the Business Standard opinion section discussing current global trade regulations and domestic economic challenges. An editorial roundup examining the impact of UK-EU carbon-border rules on small exporters, alongside discussions on India's financial sector, gender gaps, China's economy, and Aligarh's history. Today's editorials and columns examine India's financial sector, gender gaps in apprenticeships, UK-EU carbon-border rules, China's economic vulnerabilities and a book exploring Aligarh's history

Business Standard

GS2 ECI's defence on SIR is shaky

The Election Commission of India filed an affidavit in the Supreme Court on October 26 regarding the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The ECI claims that the revision and its procedural alterations are within its constitutional remit and that decisions were unanimous. Public facts and recorded objections by two Election Commissioners contradict the claim that the decisions were collective or unanimous. The ECI stated that an additional declaration prescribed for Form 6 was a separate document rather than a rule amendment.

Deccan Herald

GS3 GST's new enforcement era: an assurance of accountability without personal liberty becoming a casualty

An editorial highlights the GST Councils decision to restrain arrest powers and protect personal liberty during tax enforcement. The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council deserves credit for removing the powers of officers to arrest even without a showcause notice. This does not mean the law is going soft. Just keep your dealings clean and the agencies will be out of your hair.

Mint

GS2 How to stop the US-Israel war on Iran

The United States and Israel are planning renewed joint strikes targeting Iran's petrochemical and nuclear facilities, with a timetable linked to the upcoming midterm elections. Washington's long-standing hostility towards Iran stems from a desire to maintain American hegemony over a crucial geopolitical pivot commanding the Gulf and the Strait of Hormuz. The author argues that US-Israeli military actions, naval blockades, and attempts to overthrow the Iranian regime threaten to plunge the entire Middle East into a severe crisis.

Al Jazeera

GS2 GS3 Operationalise life cover for delivery workers

A 33-year-old delivery rider in Hyderabad died of a heart attack after a long shift, revealing that platform insurance covers only accidental deaths. India has 1.2 crore gig workers currently, a number projected to reach 2.3 crore by 2030 according to NITI Aayog. The core issue is that existing platform insurance and many legal frameworks exclude natural deaths, leaving families without financial support.

BusinessLine

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | Commodity price pressures threaten threaten to make India's inflation fight harder

The editorial highlights how increasing commodity prices and food inflation are placing renewed pressure on India's economy. Rising commodity prices and food inflation are threatening to make India's battle against inflation much harder. With commodity prices on the rise alongside food inflation, India's twin deficits are likely to remain under pressure. Even if the cost of metals and other commodities come down next year, as forecasted by the Word Bank, controlling other price increases will be tough.

Mint

GS3 India's strong GDP numbers: What use are they if people don't benefit?

The persistent disconnect between strong macroeconomic GDP numbers and stagnant real incomes for Indian workers. The editorial critiques India's high GDP growth figures, arguing that they do not translate to better living standards or rising real incomes for ordinary workers. India's flashy GDP figures don't reveal the pain. Real incomes haven't risen in years and corporate profits have swollen. In contrast, competing economies such as Vietnam have seen real incomes rise.

Mint

GS2 Maldives and Pakistan have set ambitious targets that raise questions

Maldivian President Mohamed Muizzu undertook a three-day state visit to Pakistan from 20 to 22 October, marking his first such visit since taking office in 2023. The visit broke an 11-year hiatus in high-level presidential visits between the two nations, following President Abdulla Yameen's trip in 2015. Muizzu held high-level meetings with Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, President Asif Ali Zardari, and Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir. The Maldivian President also addressed the Maldives-Pakistan Business Forum during his itinerary in Islamabad.

ThePrint

GS2 Four-Year Undergraduate Programme: Students are paying the price of policy confusion

Implementation of the Four-Year Undergraduate Programme in Delhi University faces severe imbroglios, notably leaving fourth-year pass-outs stranded regarding one-year postgraduate programme admissions. Unclear priority parameters and last-minute rule changes have driven affected students to approach courts seeking legal relief against admission denials. The core issue stems from policy confusion, poor infrastructure, and guidelines formulated after programmes commence, leaving students and teachers insecure and clueless.

Indian Express

GS3 The unequal geography of India's economic activity—and how to address it

The persistent regional economic disparity and the need for structural policy responses like Finance Commission incentives put this topic in the news. The article discusses the unequal geography of economic activity in India, arguing that market forces will sustain this asymmetry and drive migration, requiring empowered urban local bodies and incentivized state policies. Strong market forces indicate the asymmetry will stay and lead to migration to developed states. Urban local bodies must be empowered to absorb their flows.

Mint

GS3 Cyclone Arnab: The rupee follows the wind

The opinion piece was published in the Indian Express on October 29, 2026. An editorial column analyzing the impact of external shocks like Cyclone Arnab on the stability and movement of the Indian rupee. India has mastered the logistics of saving lives, but remains vulnerable to the financial ruin that follows

Indian Express

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Jamia student protest: Why is the Lyngdoh Committee report significant? The Lyngdoh Committee report gained attention recently due to student protests at Jamia Millia Islamia. This explainer details the origin and significance of the Lyngdoh Committee report in the context of student union elections and campus protests.

The Hindu

Inter-State Council – Significance & Limitations The Inter-State Council is a mechanism conceived to promote cooperative federalism in India, but it has largely remained dormant due to infrequent meetings and operational limitations. The Inter-State Council Secretariat was set up in 1991 and has also functioned as the secretariat for Zonal Councils since 2011.

ForumIAS

Knowledge Nugget | New underground amphibian discovered in Western Ghats: What makes it significant? The discovery was highlighted as a knowledge nugget for UPSC current affairs. Researchers have discovered a new underground amphibian species in the Western Ghats region. UPSC Current Affairs: A village backyard in Maharashtra has revealed a species that spends most of its life hidden underground.

Indian Express

Why SC panel wants curbs on tourism, tighter rules for roads, hydropower in Himachal The recommendations were made by the SC panel to address mounting environmental concerns and frequent disasters in the Himalayan state. A Supreme Court appointed committee has recommended strict curbs on tourism, tighter regulations for road construction, and scrutiny of hydropower projects in Himachal Pradesh to protect its ecology.

Indian Express

US's Freedom of Navigation ops against India: What it means for bilateral ties The report highlights the geopolitical significance and policy differences between the US and India regarding maritime governance under UNCLOS. The United States conducted Freedom of Navigation operations against India to challenge domestic maritime claims that require prior consent for foreign military exercises in the EEZ.

Indian Express

This October, Mumbai surpassed Delhi in air pollution rankings. Here's why An analysis was published explaining why Mumbai surpassed Delhi in air pollution rankings this October. Mumbai recorded higher air pollution levels compared to Delhi in October, raising concerns over deteriorating urban air quality.

Firstpost

Why Punjab can't shake off drug crisis: Role of history, geography, economics The persistent socio-economic challenge of the drug menace in Punjab brought the historical and geographical factors into focus. This explainer details the deep-rooted historical, geographical, and economic reasons behind Punjab's persistent drug crisis.

Indian Express

Is GRAP enough to curb pollution? It appears as an explainer to analyze the effectiveness of emergency pollution control measures. This explainer examines the adequacy of the Graded Response Action Plan in curbing severe air pollution in the National Capital Region.

Civilsdaily

Why India rejected a patent application for shorter drug-resistant TB treatment The Indian Patent Office rejected a patent application for BPaL, a three-medicine combination that cuts drug-resistant TB treatment to six months. The application for bedaquiline, pretomanid and linezolid was filed by the US-based non-profit Global Alliance for TB Drug Development.

The Hindu

Parallel electricity distributors: Why Centre wants private players The Centre's push through updated rules has triggered a debate over parallel power distribution and state resistance. The Centre is promoting parallel electricity distribution networks to foster private competition, while states like Haryana are resisting the move due to fears of financial instability for state discoms.

Indian Express

Can India's cybersecurity safeguards keep pace with AI agents? Recent AI agent intrusions into various Indian companies put the spotlight on national cybersecurity preparedness. Recent AI agent intrusions into Indian companies have exposed vulnerabilities in existing cybersecurity safeguards, sparking debates on national preparedness.
Frontline

What Is 'Logical Discrepancy' In SIR? Why Supreme Court Wants To Test Its Legality The Supreme Court clarified that the Election Commission of India's use of logical discrepancy checks during the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls is not legally settled. A bench comprising CJI Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi, and Justice V Mohana questioned how electoral entries can be reopened based on patterns from revision exercises.
news18.com

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth to Inaugurate -2026 (VISV-2026), Showcasing India's Indigenous Defence Capabilities and Global Partnerships (Defence) PIB
- Census trainers flag queries on Aadhaar, caste, age and birthplace of parents as key challenges (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Supreme Court dismisses Mahua Moitra plea for disclosure of ultimate beneficial owners of AIFs, FPIs (Economy) Bar & Bench
- NCLT administration completely hijacked by Ministry of Corporate Affairs: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Bar & Bench
- ECI extends SIR timelines in Maharashtra, Delhi, Andhra, Haryana, Telangana, Nagaland (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, Shri Piyush Goyal Calls for Greater FTA Utilisation by Telangana (Economy) PIB
- [Answered] Does centralizing climate-resilient, season-independent crops empower smallholders beyond MSP protections? Analyze the governance and institutional shifts necessary for sustainable livelihoods. (Agriculture & Allied) ForumIAS
- Election Commission's SIR exercise identifies just 1,600 foreigners on voter lists in six states (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- Govt releases voluntary data sharing framework for power sector (Governance & Policy) BusinessLine
- Exercise IN-RoKN (Defence) Vajiram & Ravi
- Jaishankar likely to meet Rubio on G20 sidelines, but trade deal remains elusive (International Relations) BusinessLine
- 14th International Tourism Mart Inaugurated in Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh (Geography) Hindustan Times
- Dearness Allowance (DA): How Inflation Affects Government Employees' Salaries (Economy) Vajiram & Ravi
- Kanha National Park: One of India's Most Beautiful Tiger Reserves (Environment & Ecology) Akasa Air
- India and Tanzania hold Army Staff Talks, discuss strengthening defence cooperation (International Relations) Economic Times
- Price stability top policy agenda in H2FY27 amid inflation: FinMin review (Economy) Business Standard
- CAG impact report shows recoveries worth Rs. 4,251 crore after audit in FY26 (Economy) Business Standard
- Centre Releases New Guidelines To Strengthen Adult Literacy Across India (Education) NDTV
- Hardeep Singh Puri Visits Mauritius; India, Mauritius Sign Oil and Gas Cooperation Pact (International Relations) DD News
- Supreme Court Upholds Union of India in Defence of India Act Case — Compensation Provisions Validated. The court affirmed that the absence of solatium and interest provisions in the Defence of India Act does not violate Article 14 of the Constitution. (Polity & Constitution) Lawtext
- Sri Lankan Navy joins first BIMSTEC maritime security exercise in India (International Relations) Tamil Guardian
- Which of the following statements with regard to agriculture under the Mughal Empire is/are correct? 1. New crops tobacco, maize, chillies, and tomatoes were introduced into Indian agriculture during the Mughal period via Portuguese maritime trade. 2. Ain-i-A (History, Art & Culture) ForumIAS
- First top-level Quad Summit under Trump administration likely in Manila (International Relations) The Economic Times
- LG reviews Delhi's readiness to host BRICS Summit 2026 (International Relations) DD News
- India and South Korea discuss joint military technology development and industry collaboration (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- IG Defence, Oman's MSA Global explore production of drone systems (Defence) YourStory.com
- Massive Mechanisation: Central scheme supports over 21.6 lakh farmers with agricultural machinery since launch (Agriculture & Allied) DD News
- Turkey Says COP31 Climate Summit to Focus on Clean Energy Shift (Environment & Ecology) EnergyNow
- Railway Board approves Bengaluru-Mumbai Vande Bharat Sleeper train: Check route, stops, timings (Infrastructure & Energy) Indian Express
- "Neutrality in the face of grave human suffering may itself become a form of moral indifference." Analyse the ethical dilemma between impartiality and moral responsibility in humanitarian action. (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- TB Alliance fails to get patent for six-month treatment regimen (Health) Hindustan Times
- Checkmating with a dam (Environment & Ecology) Frontline
- India successfully tests Agni 5, an intermediate range ballistic missile (Defence) ET Government
- Accused must explain source of excess wealth, not investigators: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- Hill stations across the Western Ghats bear monsoon fury (Environment & Ecology) Frontline

- SC asks ECI if voter laxity can be punished with loss of voting rights forever (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- North India getting hotter, drier, South wetter: A study of 70-year climate trends uncovers worrying climate shift (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- Financial Inclusion in India: Banking Every Citizen, Empowering Every Household (Economy) Press Information Bureau
- Accused must explain disproportionate assets or face adverse inference: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Deccan Herald
- Supreme Court's latest ruling on arrest grounds puts personal liberty safeguard to test (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- Global Quantum Technology Initiatives (Science & Technology) Observer Research Foundation
- May instruct courts not to give bail in digital arrest cases: SC (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- One Signature, 166 Sq Km, A Withdrawn Consent: Great Nicobar's Forest Rights Puzzle (Environment & Ecology) Outlook India
- Green financing in India rises to $82 billion, but flows mostly to established sectors: Report (Economy) Economic Times
- NPPA Cuts Prices of 543 Cancer Drug Brands by Up to 93 Percent (Health) illustrated Daily News
- Antarctic sea ice loss coincides with rising ocean salinity, IISc-led study finds (Environment & Ecology) ThePrint
- U.S. Fed holds rates steady; pressure on emerging markets expected with stronger dollar outlook (Economy) The Hindu
- Inter-State Council is a meeting point that has withered away. It must be rebuilt (Polity & Constitution) Civilsdaily
- US 'colder' towards India as it sees us as rival in market for resources: CEA Nageswaran (International Relations) Indian Express

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 23 must-know, 23 Prelims facts, 49 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (10), Economy (8), Environment & Ecology (6), International Relations (6), Governance & Policy (5), Social Justice & Welfare (4), Agriculture & Allied (2), Disaster Management (2), Defence (1), Internal Security (1), Science & Technology (1). **Nothing today in —** Health, Education, Infrastructure & Energy, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 3 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 4 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 2 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 3

Full text — 45 of 73 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 11, Indian Express 8, PIB 8, ddnews.gov.in 5, Economic Times 4, Vajiram & Ravi 4, Mint 4, Bar & Bench 2, Hindustan Times 2, deccanherald.com 2, msn.com 1, Times of India 1, telanganatoday.com 1, TaxCorp AI 1

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